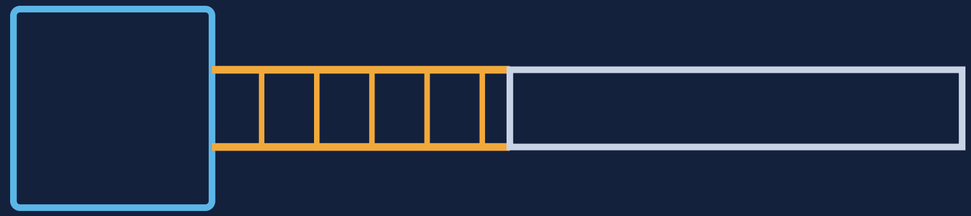
HVAC STUFF · USER GUIDE

Flex Tail

The end of a rigid duct at an element becomes flex — in one click



Revit 2023–2027 · Flex Tail · version 1.0

OVERVIEW

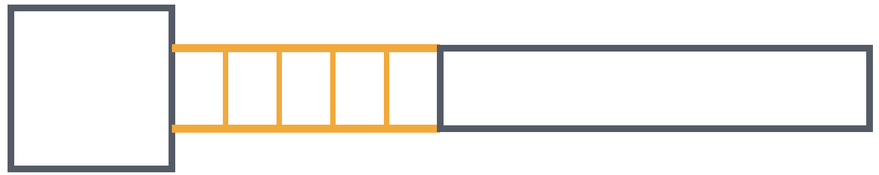
What the command does

Before



The rigid duct runs right up to the air terminal.

After

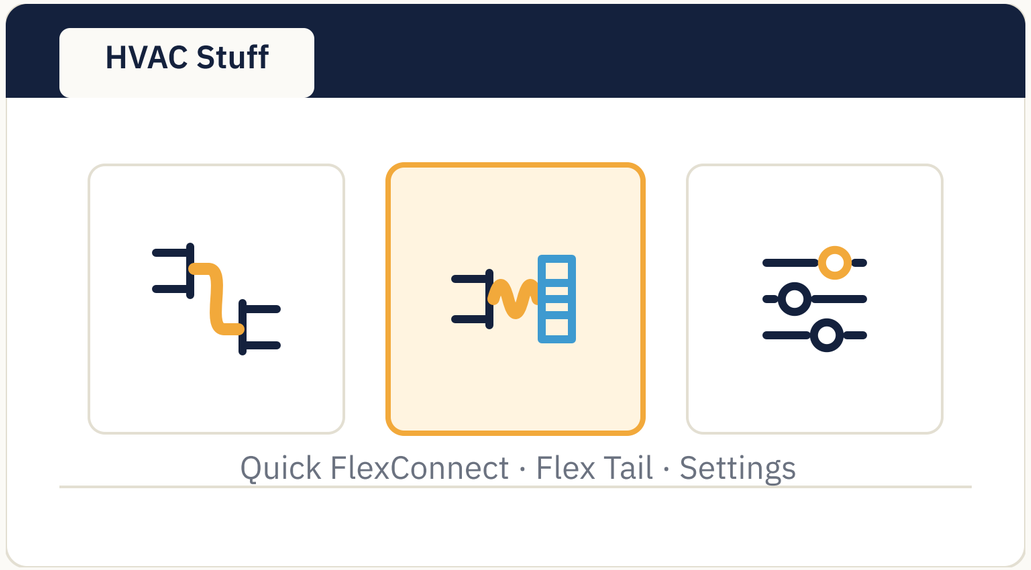


A flex segment of the same size at the element, then the rest of the duct.

Size, system and joints are kept. You set the flex length.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Ribbon: HVAC Stuff → Ductwork



The Flex Tail button is the second on the **Ductwork** panel of the **HVAC Stuff** tab.

Works only in a project, in these views:

- floor, ceiling, or structural plan;
- section;
- 3D view without perspective.

In families, sheets, elevations and perspective views the button is grayed out.

QUICK START

Three steps to a flex segment

1

Click the element

Near the connector the rigid duct is joined to. The connector gets marked.

2

Length in the window

Type a number or click 500… 2500 or Whole segment (the whole route). The flex duct is already shown in gray.

3

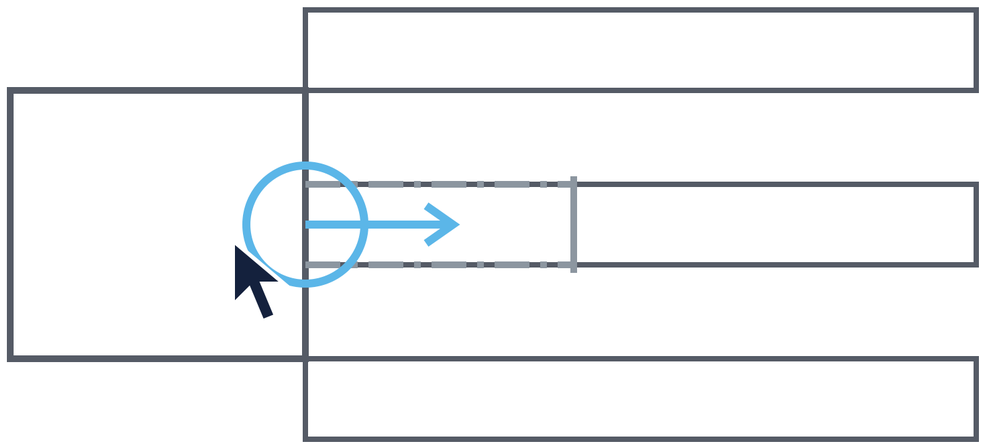
OK

The flex segment stays in the model. Esc — nothing changes.

Works with: equipment, accessories, fittings, air terminals.

WHERE TO CLICK

Click the element, not the duct



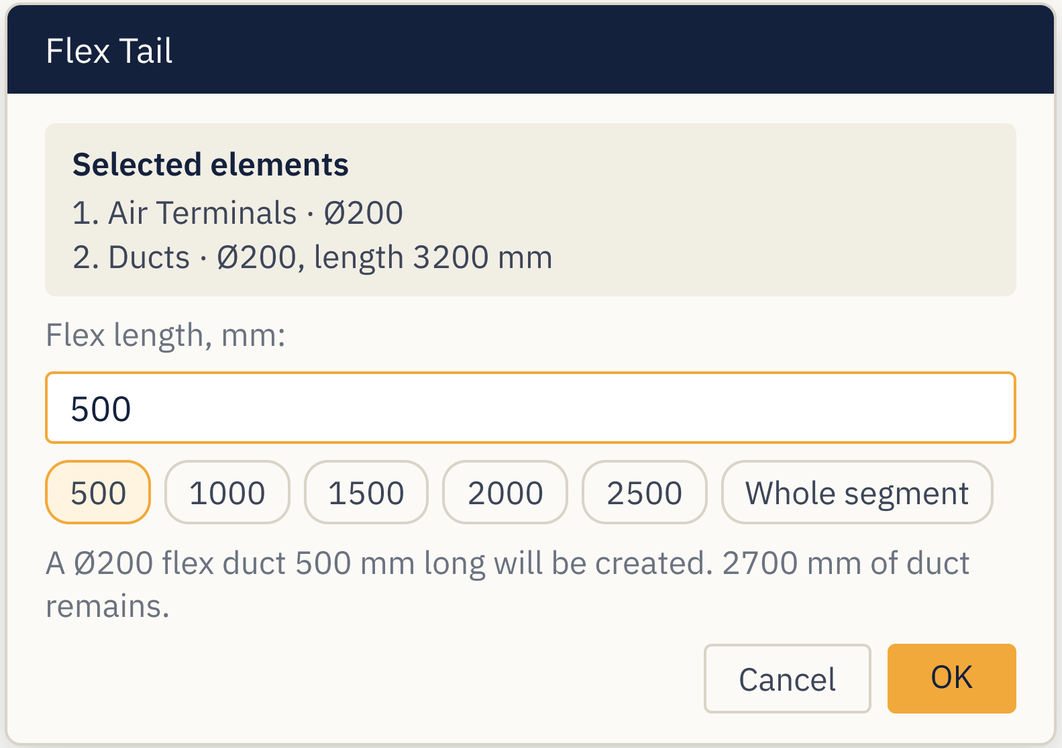
Click equipment, an accessory, a fitting, or an air terminal — near the connector you need.

The mark shows the connector nearest to the pointer on the screen; **the gray outline** — the future flex segment.

If no rigid duct is joined to the connector, a message explains why the element cannot be used.

THE COMMAND WINDOW

Length and type — with a live preview



The real flex duct is already in the model — in gray, both ends marked. Every change rebuilds it.

The line under the values says what happens: what the flex duct replaces (behind an elbow — ducts and elbows), how much rigid duct remains and the real length.

Flex type — the list under the length; remembered for each section shape.

LENGTH RULES

The length follows the route, and it is exact

Longer than the first duct

Flex duct replaces the first duct, the elbow and as much of the next ducts as the length reaches — through any number of elbows of the same size. The length counts along the axes from the connector. If it fits into the first duct, it works as before and the elbow stays.

Longer than the whole route

The maximum length is put in: the length of the whole route. A tee, a transition, a flex duct or a free end stops the route. The window stays open.

Whole segment

The whole route up to a tee, a transition or the end becomes flex — the length equals the length of the whole route.

Length from 5 to 50,000 mm. 500 mm by default; the last length typed is remembered (settings).

The length is exact to 0.1 mm: the end of the flex duct is found by trial builds, and the window and the message show the real length. Through an elbow the flex duct is not shorter than the minimum needed to reach the next duct: then the minimum is built and a note appears.

If the rigid leftover would be shorter than 1/10 inch, the whole duct is converted.

SERIES AND UNDO

Element after element, one click each

Action	What happens
Continue	The next element of the same section shape is converted at once — same length and type, no window.
Shift + click	Hold Shift while clicking — the window opens again to change the length or type.
Esc	Ends the series. Converted elements stay.
Ctrl + Z	Each element is a separate step, “Flex Tail: rigid duct to flex”.

The Revit status bar shows how many elements are converted.

SETTINGS

The Settings button on the panel

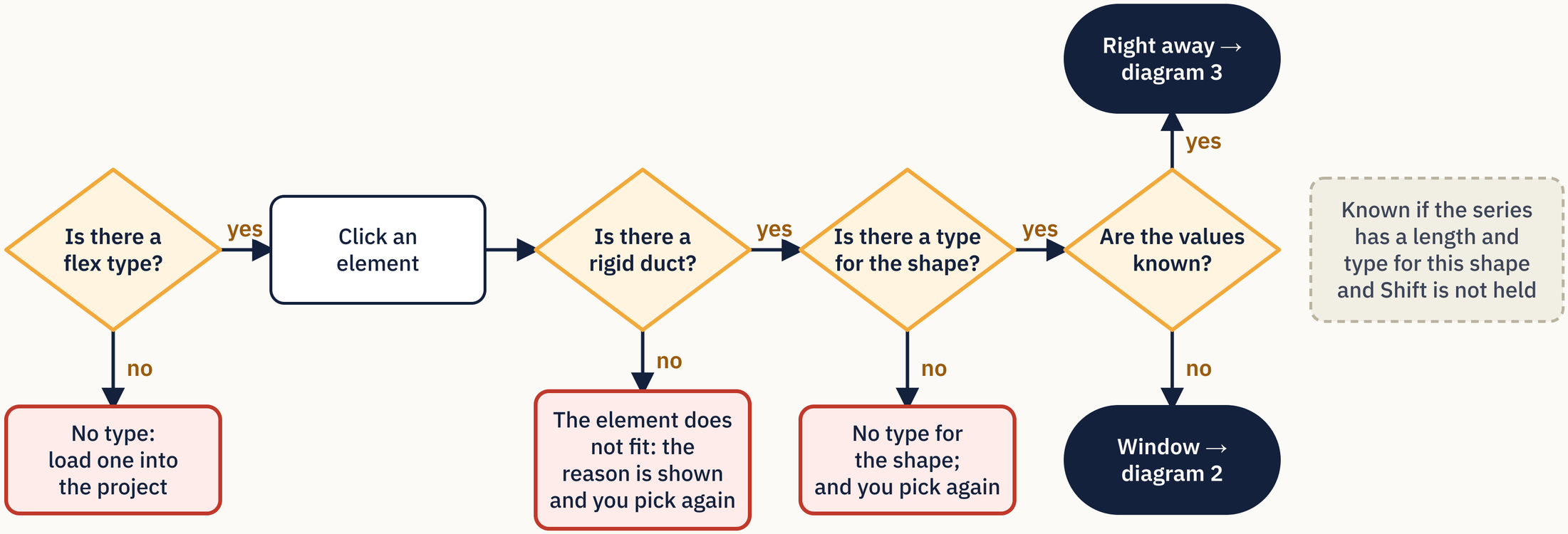
Setting	What it changes
Flex Pattern	The Flex Pattern value of new flex ducts (default Flex).
Default length	The length the window starts with, mm (default 500).
Remember the length	The window starts with the last entered length.
Loop	The next element after this one — until Esc.
Color, outline, language	The General tab — shared by both commands.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Frequently asked questions

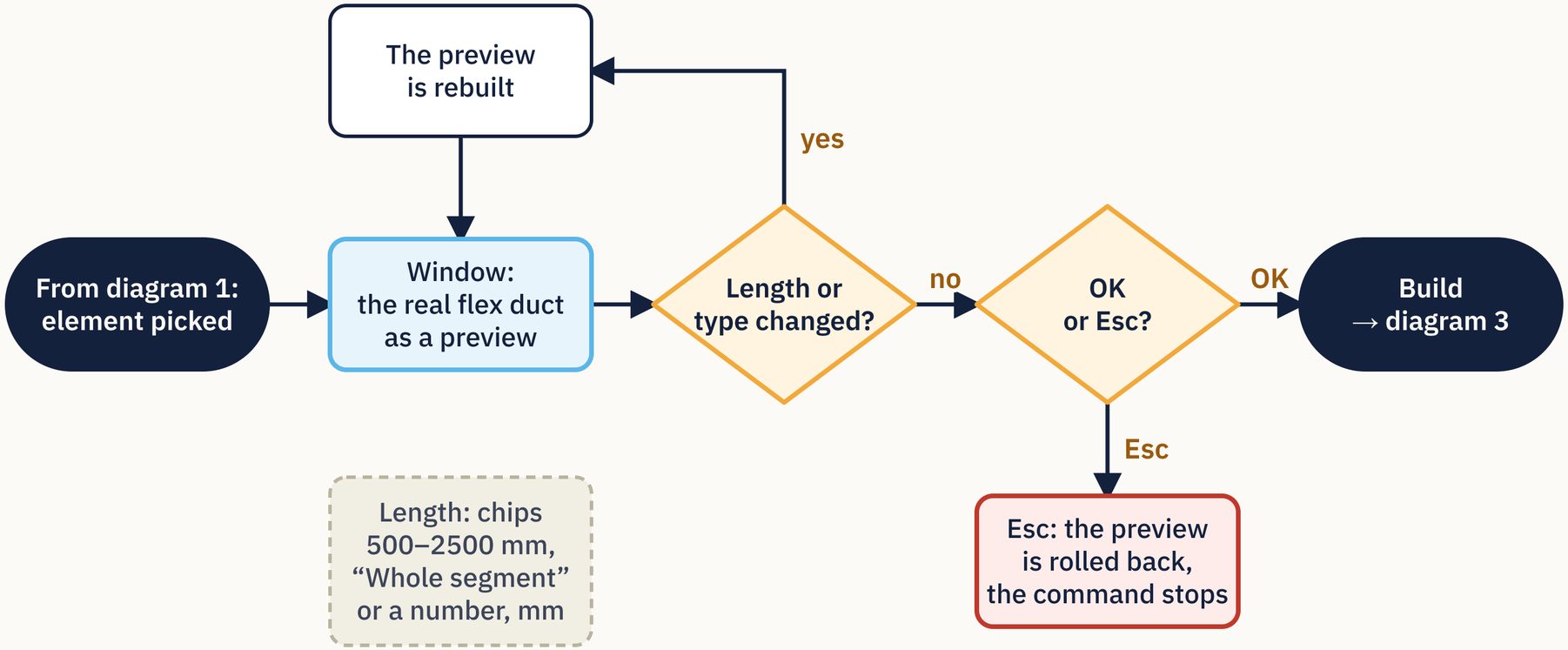
Situation	What to do
The button is grayed out	Open a plan, a section, or a 3D view without perspective in a project.
Clicking the duct does nothing	Click the element the duct is joined to, near its connector.
“This element cannot be used”	The nearest connector has no rigid duct — click closer to another one.
“No flex type for the shape”	Load a flex duct type of that shape into the project.
The whole segment was converted	The length is greater than the whole route, or the rigid leftover would be too short — see the length rules.
The flex duct is longer than I typed	Through an elbow the flex duct cannot be shorter than the minimum needed to reach the next duct. The minimum was built, and the summary has a note.
An error	Click Copy in the message window and send the text to the developer.

Picking an element and the checks



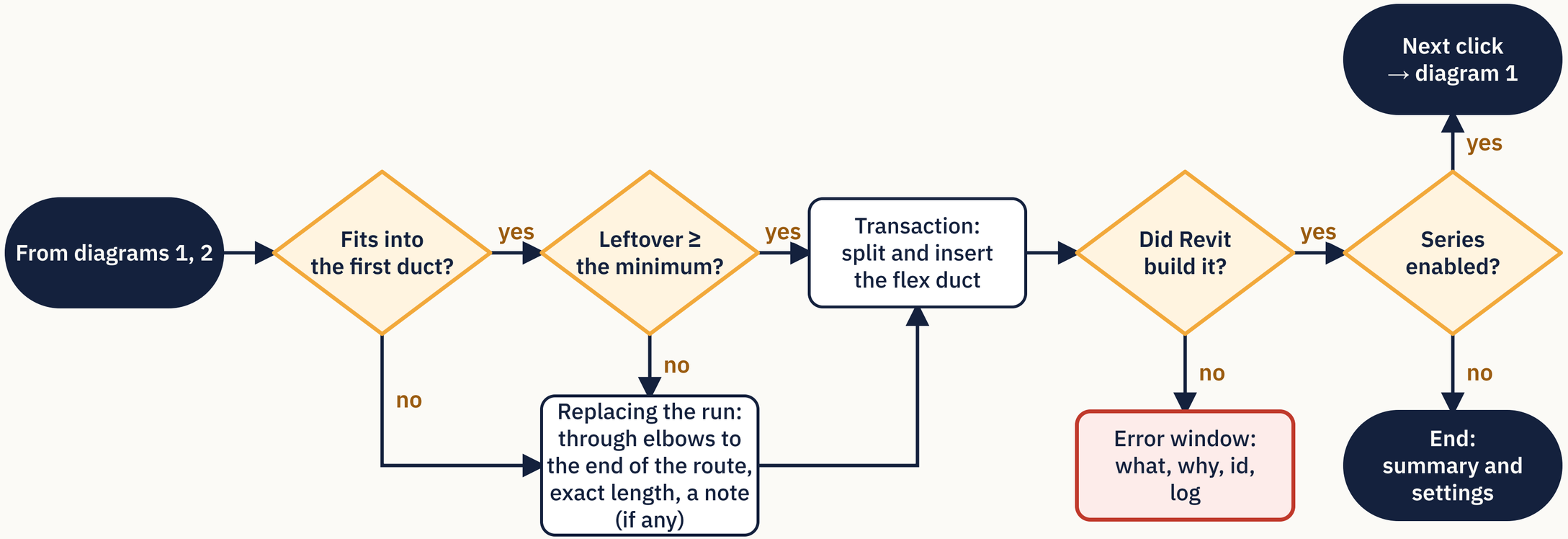
Esc ends the command. After a red message you pick again without restarting.

The window with a live preview



Every change of length or type rebuilds the real flex duct. OK keeps it, Esc rolls it back and ends the command.

Length, building and the series



A length longer than the first duct goes behind the elbows up to the end of the route, and a leftover that is too short turns the whole duct flex. The length is exact; deviations get a note.

HVAC STUFF

One click — and the duct end is flex

New versions, installers and guides: github.com/iMrVoLaNd/HVAC-Stuff-Releases

Help from Revit: point at the button and press **F1**.

Also in the add-in: Quick FlexConnect — a flex duct between two connectors in two clicks.